peace. India also took up the cause of the 'black' population in USA and also the African population of Rhodesia (Zimbabwe). She had also used the NAM platform to support the struggle of the people against racialism and apartheid. India still believes in the relevance of its anti-racial policy, and therefore, continues to fight against such practice against humanity.

4. *Panchsheel or Peaceful Coexistence:* The cardinal principle of Indian foreign policy is *Panchsheel* or peaceful coexistence. It was in 1954 that Beijing and New Delhi jointly proposed *Five Principles of Peaceful Coexistence* (known as **Panchsheel** in India) primarily to guide the bilateral relations between them. The Five Principles of peaceful coexistence, collectively known as *Panchsheel,* were enunciated by the Chinese Premier Zhou Enlai and the Indian Prime Minister Jawaharlal Nehru during the negotiations on the India–China Agreement on Tibet concluded on 29 April 1954. But the Five Principles were nothing new to India and can be found in the ancient scriptures. Moral, spiritual, religious and cultural teachings have been inculcating the spirit of mutual respect, tolerance, peaceful coexistence and respect for each other's integrity and independence among its people for centuries.[3]

These five principles of Panchsheel are:

1. Mutual respect for each other's territorial integrity and sovereignty
2. Mutual non-aggression
3. Mutual non-interference in each other's internal affairs
4. Equality and mutual benefit
5. Peaceful coexistence.

The *Panchsheel* became the moving force behind Asian and African movements for equality and freedom against domination of the world by colonial and imperialist powers and was also endorsed by the UN. Although the Five Principles of Panchsheel are quintessentially reflected in the UN Charter, drafted a decade earlier than the *Panchsheel,* the then UN Secretary-General Dag Hammarskjold aptly described them as "reaffirmation of the aims and obligations of the United Nations". *Panchsheel* got wider acceptability when the